Stefan Penchev

Full-Stack & Backend Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack and backend developer building recruitment products and internal operations software. Previously developed ArtAICare's MERN web platform as its sole programmer, integrating Python components and deploying to an Ubuntu VPS.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DTO Partners — Software Engineer

Remote | Jan 2025–Present | Part-time, project-based engagement

Design and full-stack development of an international recruitment platform and a multilingual company website.

- Implement recruitment-platform workflows covering candidate onboarding, candidate discovery, saved profiles and recruiter expressions of interest.
- Develop candidate, company and administrator workspaces, implementing authentication, role-based access control (RBAC) and privacy controls.
- Build dashboards and analytics that present recruitment activity and user engagement.
- Built the initial informational website without a backend; continue developing the responsive company website with English and Polish localisation.

Stack across products: Rust, Angular, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Redis.
Development and delivery: Automated testing, Docker and CI/CD workflows.

Skald Solutions — Software Developer

Bulgaria | Jul–Oct 2026 | Paid internship

- Implemented the Skald Lab Ops backend for a youth workshop (ages 8–18), covering member records, session bookings, attendance tracking and project-progress management.
- Built Egil, a local retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) assistant that searches a curated business-audit knowledge base and uses Ollama for local model execution, supporting queries on audit methodology and business failure modes.
- Contributed to a Bulgarian-language catalogue containing 90 hands-on projects and supporting educational materials for Skald Lab participants.

Stack across projects: Django, Ollama.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

ArtAICare — Software Engineer

Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxembourg | Jan–Sep 2025 | Internship

Sole programmer for the art-therapy web platform within a wider product team.

- Designed and implemented the MERN web architecture, backend services and APIs.
- Integrated Python-based recommendation functionality and Sentence-BERT (SBERT).
- Collaborated with the VR developer to integrate the web platform with the VR application.
- Built a study-specific application based on the main platform, integrating EEG data and Python scripts for a university research project examining participants' brain activity.
- Configured an Ubuntu VPS and deployed the web application using Nginx, with remote administration through SSH.

Stack: MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js, Python, Sentence-BERT, Nginx, Ubuntu, SSH.

MindHub Coding Schools — Teacher

Pazardzhik, Bulgaria | Sep 2023–Sep 2024

- Taught children aged 8–12 programming fundamentals through Scratch projects, games and exercises focused on mathematical reasoning, logical thinking and algorithms.
- Taught teenagers Python and JavaScript alongside HTML and CSS; also guided hands-on programming activities using micro:bit.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Rust, Go, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, C++.
Backend: Node.js, Express.js, Django.
Frontend: React, Angular, Next.js, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Sass, Material UI.
Databases and data access: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis; Mongoose, Prisma.
Backend platforms: Firebase, Supabase.
AI integration: Sentence-BERT, Ollama, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG).
Development and delivery: Git, GitHub, Docker, Linux, Nginx, SSH, CI/CD.
Testing and API tools: Jest, Vitest, Cypress, Playwright; Swagger, Postman.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

University of Luxembourg — Bachelor in Computer Science

Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxembourg | Sep 2024–Present

Third and final year. Academic focus: software engineering, machine learning and security.

Erasmus exchange — TU Wien, Vienna | Feb–Jul 2026 (completed)

One semester in Informatics, with an academic focus on autonomous racing with C++ and Python.

IT Kariera — Certificate in Software Development

Ministry of Education Bulgaria, Plovdiv | Completed Jul 2024

Completed a two-year programme in C#, MySQL, Haskell and PHP, including C++/Arduino projects.

LANGUAGES

Bulgarian: Native | **English:** C1